Atrium user guides

Atrium Tablinum (short: **Atrium**) is your organisation's shared memory for AI assistants: a place where knowledge and approved working instructions ("skills") are kept, found and reused by Claude, ChatGPT and other assistants that speak the Model Context Protocol (MCP). These guides explain how to work with it, one guide per group of people.

You do not operate Atrium through a screen of its own. You talk to your AI assistant ("Search Atrium for our expense policy", "File this in the Support space") and the assistant uses Atrium's tools on your behalf. The guides therefore show what to say, what happens behind the scenes, and which tool is involved when you need to look something up or report a problem.

Which guide is for me?

Guide	For	You will learn
Why Atrium	Everybody, and anyone who still needs convincing	What Atrium brings you, your team and the organisation, a day with it, your first ten minutes, and the honest limits. A good document to share first
Getting started	New users	Connect your assistant, ask a first question, save a first note and find it again in a new chat, in about five minutes. The first guide to read
1. Everyday use	Everybody who has an Atrium login	Connect an assistant, find knowledge, use skills, work in your personal space, hand work over to another assistant, stay safe
2. Authors	People who may write in team spaces	File and maintain knowledge, work with drafts and approval, write and propose skills
3. Curators	People who review and approve	Review knowledge and skills, judge risk, publish, block, keep a space tidy
4. Space admins	People who manage one space	Members, roles and groups, access reviews, unblocking, deleting
5. Instance admins	The people who run the Atrium instance	Spaces, users, offboarding, login rules, context, audit, health, security and operations
Atrium Pro	Instance admins (and space admins) of an organisation with a Pro licence	Install and renew the licence, updates with a licence, the user limit, guided offboarding, separating content from operations

Each guide builds on the one before it: a curator is also an author and a reader, a space admin is also a curator, and so on. Read the guides in order if you are new to a role. Every guide ends with a short FAQ.

Roles at a glance

Access is organised in **spaces**. A space is a collection of knowledge entries and skills with its own members. There are two kinds:

- **Team spaces** belong to the organisation. Members have one of four roles in each space.
- **Personal spaces** belong to one person. Only the owner can read them, not even instance admins.

Role in a space	Can do
Reader	Search, read and list approved knowledge; use released skills
Author	Everything a reader can, plus file knowledge, change and move their own entries, propose skills
Curator	Everything an author can, plus review drafts and skills, change entries of others, publish and block skills
Admin (space admin)	Everything a curator can, plus manage the members of the space, lift skill blocks, delete entries for good
Instance admin	Admin in every team space, plus the `admin_*` tools to create spaces, manage users, logins and the audit log. Cannot read personal spaces

The role you have can differ from space to space. Your assistant can show your roles with the tool `list_spaces`, and `space_contacts` tells you who the curators and admins are.

> **Rights, precisely.** "Space admin" and "instance admin" are different. A space admin manages one space (`space_members`, `space_add_member`, `space_remove_member`, `unblock_skill`, `delete_knowledge`). An instance admin counts as admin in every team space and additionally has the `admin_*` tools. Sources in the code: `internal/authz`, `internal/docs/write.go`, `internal/skills/skills.go`.

Words used in the guides

Term	Meaning
Entry (knowledge entry)	A piece of knowledge in Markdown with a title, tags and a version history. Data, never an instruction
Skill	An approved working instruction for an assistant: a `SKILL.md` plus optional text files. Immutable once released
Draft	An entry or skill version waiting for review. Visible only to its author and the curators of the space

Term	Meaning
Approved / released	Reviewed and visible to all readers of the space
Handoff	A short summary stored in your personal space so you can continue in another assistant
Type	What an entry is: `rule` (binding, set by curators only), `documentation`, `recommendation`, `experience`
Responsible person	Who answers for an entry, if somebody named one; marked `former` after they left
Review date	The day by which an entry should be checked; an overdue review is shown, nothing is hidden
Digest	A SHA-256 fingerprint of a skill version. Reviewers approve a specific digest
Instance	One running Atrium for one organisation

About these documents

- Markdown (`.md`) is the source. A PDF with the same name sits next to every guide for printing and offline reading.
- The guides describe the behaviour of the current development version. Features that are planned but not built are marked as such, and the roadmap lists what is coming.
- Organisations with a Pro licence also read Atrium Pro (licence, guided offboarding and content separation, in `docs/pro/`).
- Technical reference for operators lives in the other documents of this repository: skills, approval, archive and context, offboarding, login and OAuth, deployment, embedding, releases.

Every PDF carries the same branding: the Atrium icon and the behringer24 logo in a header block on the first page, a running header on every other page, and a footer with the names and the page number. To rebuild the PDFs after editing a guide, run `scripts/build-docs.sh` (needs Node.js and Chrome, Chromium or Edge); pass the changed file to rebuild only that one.